

Maximilian J. Gebauer

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EDUCATION

University of Pennsylvania — Ph.D. Candidate, Philosophy

Areas of specialization: Philosophy of Science; Bayesianism. Areas of competence: Political Philosophy; Environmental Philosophy.

Aug.
2022–expected
Spring 2027

The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania — M.A., Statistics & Data Science

Thesis: “Sparse Control Selection For Spatial Epidemiological Data: Double Lasso And County COVID-19 Mortality.”

May 2026

Washington and Lee University — B.A.

Philosophy & Poverty and Human Capability Studies, *magna cum laude*; Honors in Philosophy.

May 2022

University of Oxford, Mansfield College — Visiting Student Programme

Fall 2020–Summer
2021

PUBLICATION

“Bayesian Practice and the Persistence of Inductive Risk”

Philosophy of Science.

Forthcoming

UNIVERSITY TEACHING

Instructor and Teaching Assistant, University of Pennsylvania

Instructor for Philosophy of Science and Introduction to Statistics. Teaching-assistant portfolio: Philosophy of Science; Logic; Bioethics; Philosophy of Climate Science; Modern Data Mining; Applied Bayesian Modeling; Applied Regression Analysis; Introduction to Statistics in Health Policy.

2023–present

SELECTED TALKS

“Approximating Posterior Distributions with Variational Bayes”

Applied Bayesian Modeling.

2025

“A Dynamic Rating Scheme for NFL Pass Rushers”

New England Symposium for Statistics in Sports; Wharton Sport Analytics and Business Summit.

2025

“Judgment and Decision-making under Uncertainty”

Repairing the Planet: Tools for the Climate Emergency.

2025

“Expected Utility Maximization and Environmental Decision-making”

Repairing the Planet: Tools for the Climate Emergency.

2025

ACADEMIC LEADERSHIP

- Chair, “AI as Method” symposium, 29th Biennial Meeting of the Philosophy of Science Association, 2024.
- Chair, “Applied Ethics” colloquium, 119th Annual Meeting of the Eastern Division of the American Philosophical Association, 2023.
- Co-developed a new introductory logic course at the University of Pennsylvania, 2024.

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Lead, Wharton Analytics Fellows

Built reproducible data-processing and predictive-modeling workflows for confidential applied research.

Dec. 2025–May
2026

Summer Lab Associate, Wharton Sports Analytics and Business Initiative

Developed dynamic sports-performance models, advised student research projects, and taught R programming.

Summer 2025

Graduate Mentor, Perry World House

Mentored an undergraduate research team on quantitative approaches in climate governance.

Sept. 2024–Feb.
2025

Intern, Center for Ethics and the Rule of Law	June–Aug. 2023
Coauthored white papers combining quantitative and qualitative analysis of proposed FISA Section 702 reforms.	
Intern, U.S. Federal District Court	May–Oct. 2020
Produced analytical research for legal–academic partnerships.	

SELECTED COURSEWORK & RESEARCH

Statistics & Data Science	Graduate coursework
Applied Regression; Bayesian Modeling; Data Mining; Observational Studies; Probability; Statistical Computing; Forecasting & Time Series; Non-parametric Methods.	
Philosophy	Graduate coursework
Philosophy of Science; Mathematical Logic; Logic; Political Philosophy; Metaethics; Contemporary Ethical Theory; Proseminar; Kant and the <i>a priori</i> ; Modern Political Philosophy; Epistemology and Perception.	
Sparse Control Selection For Spatial Epidemiological Data	M.A. thesis
Applied post-double-selection LASSO with a negative-binomial regression model and Markov random field spatial controls to investigate the association between U.S. county-level partisanship and COVID-19 mortality.	

AWARDS & FELLOWSHIPS

- Perry World House Graduate Fellow, 2025–26.
- Fishman Fellowship, University of Pennsylvania, 2022–present.
- Benjamin Franklin Fellowship, University of Pennsylvania, 2022–present.
- Fontaine Graduate Fellowship, University of Pennsylvania, 2022–present.
- Dissertation Research Award, University of Pennsylvania, 2025.
- Edward Dodd Award; Charles Thomas Boggs Prize; The Young Scholarship; William Wells Chaffin Memorial Scholarship, Washington and Lee University, 2022.
- The Grenader Family Prize, Mansfield College, University of Oxford, 2020.

METHODS & SOFTWARE

Proficient in R, Stan, and LaTeX; familiar with Python, Excel, and Stata. Methods include regression analysis, Bayesian modeling, nonparametric methods, stochastic simulation, and machine learning. Software includes RStudio, VS Code, Jupyter, GitHub, and Overleaf.